



National
Qualifications
2019

2019 ESOL

Higher

Writing

Finalised Marking Instructions

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These marking instructions have been prepared by examination teams for use by SQA appointed markers when marking external course assessments.

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General marking principles for Higher ESOL Writing

Always apply these general principles. Use them in conjunction with the detailed marking instructions, which identify the key features required in candidates' responses.

- (a) Always use positive marking. This means candidates accumulate marks for the demonstration of relevant skills, knowledge and understanding; marks are not deducted for errors or omissions.
- (b) Assessment should be holistic. There may be strengths and weaknesses in the performance; focus as far as possible on the strengths, taking account of weaknesses only where they significantly detract from the overall performance.
- (c) Do not award marks where the candidate has used in their writing chunks of text lifted en bloc from the reading passages.
- (d) Award marks where the candidate demonstrates ability according to the main criteria of content and organisation; vocabulary and spelling; and grammar and punctuation.
- (e) Award the highest level descriptor for writing even if there are a number of basic slips and errors of grammar, spelling and punctuation, etc. These should not detract from your overall impression of the candidate's performance.
- (f) Candidates may display ability across more than one band descriptor. You must consider carefully the most appropriate overall band for the candidate's performance.
- (g) Once the appropriate band descriptor has been selected, follow this guidance
 - if the evidence almost matches the level above, award the highest available mark from the range
 - if the candidate's work just meets the standard described, award the lowest mark from the range
 - otherwise award the mark from the middle of the range
- (h) The script must be legible. Do not make mark judgements based on the quality of the handwriting. If answers are written in capitals, use legibility as a criterion.

		Looking for more resources? Visit https://sga.myl/ - Scotland's #1 Parent Resource	Description of performance and mark					
	Everyday life		Work or Study	Everyday life	Work or Study	Everyday life	Work or Study	
			12-11	10-9	8			
Content and organisation	Fully achieves language flexibility and uses language effectively with clear support for each point made.	using language effectively with clear support for each point made.	Fully achieves task, using language effectively with clear support for each point made.	Fully achieves task with clear support for points made.	Achieves task with clear support for most points made.			
	Writing is coherent and cohesive with a positive impact on the reader.	Writing is coherent and cohesive with a positive impact on the reader.	Writing is coherent and cohesive with a positive impact on the reader.	Writing is coherent and cohesive and conveys message with ease.	Writing is coherent and cohesive and message is clear.			
	Style and layout are effective in achieving the intended reader. Paragraphing is coherent.	Style and layout are wholly appropriate for the intended reader. Structure/paragraphing is consistent and appropriate.	Style and layout are wholly appropriate for the intended reader. Structure/paragraphing is consistent and appropriate.	Style and layout are appropriate for the intended reader. The structure is clear and paragraphing follows conventions.	Style and layout are appropriate for the intended reader. The structure is clear and the paragraphing mainly follows conventions.			
Vocabulary and spelling	Uses an optimum range of vocabulary accurately and effectively within the context of the task. Spelling is accurate with occasional errors.	range of vocabulary and spelling is mainly accurate with occasional errors.	Uses a wide range of vocabulary accurately and effectively within the context of the task. Spelling is mainly accurate with occasional errors.	Uses a wide range of vocabulary accurately and appropriately within the context of the task. Spelling is mostly accurate and errors are not persistent.	Uses a sufficiently wide range of vocabulary with a level of accuracy appropriate to the task. Spelling is mostly accurate and any errors do not interfere with intelligibility.			
Grammar and punctuation	Uses an optimum range of grammatical structures effectively, with a high level of accuracy.	range of grammatical structures with a high level of accuracy.	Uses a wide range of grammatical structures effectively with a high level of accuracy.	Uses a wide range of grammatical structures with a reasonable level of accuracy.	Uses a sufficiently wide range of grammatical structures, and the message is conveyed with ease despite some errors.			
	Punctuation is accurate.	Punctuation is consistently accurate.	Punctuation is consistent and appropriate.	Punctuation is mostly accurate.	Punctuation is sufficiently accurate and appropriate to task purpose.			

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		Looking for more resources? Visit https://sga.nyu.edu/scott	Description of performance and mark						
	Everyday life		Work or Study	Everyday life	Work or Study	Everyday life	Work or Study	Everyday life	Work or Study
				5-3		2-1		0	
Content and organisation	Task may be a		ed.	Writing is mainly irrelevant to task.	Writing does not relate to task.	No evidence produced by candidate that matches descriptions of performance.			
	Coherence is v		n places and	Lack of coherence and cohesion means message is not conveyed on first reading.	There is little or no coherence or cohesion.				
	range of cohes		evices is						
	limited and/or		ssage may	Style and layout may be inappropriate for intended reader. Structure is confused.	Style and layout are inappropriate for intended reader. Structure is confused.				
	inappropriate		v.						
	be difficult to		y be						
	Style and layo		tended						
	inappropriate	evidence of							
	reader. There	ructure may							
	paragraphing								
	be confused.								
Vocabulary and spelling	Uses a limited	e of	Only basic vocabulary attempted, with frequent errors.	Only very basic vocabulary attempted, with very frequent errors.	No evidence produced by candidate that matches descriptions of performance.				
	vocabulary wi	ors in							
	accuracy and	priateness.							
	Persistent spe	errors may	Persistent spelling errors impede intelligibility.	Frequent and persistent spelling errors impede intelligibility.					
	interfere with	igibility.							
Grammar and punctuation	Uses only a lin	range of	Grammatical structures contain frequent errors, which impede communication.	Errors predominate.	No evidence produced by candidate that matches descriptions of performance.				
	grammatical s	res, which							
	may contain f	nt errors and							
	interfere with	nunication.							
	Punctuation m	inaccurate.	Punctuation may be inaccurate.	Punctuation is inaccurate.					

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[END OF MARKING INSTRUCTIONS]